has always faced challenges in managing the Indo–Myanmar Border (IMB). This gets compounded due to the prevalent Free Move Regime (FMR), poor/no connectivity towards the IMB from either side, thickly forested hilly terrain and overlapping ethnic spread astride the IMB. This readily available ecosystem has led to the accumulation of various IIGs in distinct clusters astride the IMB on the Myanmar side. Owing to our persistent counter-insurgency operations, the indices of violence in the hinterland on our side had declined to marginal levels. However, the ecosystem of the IIGs in these camps astride the IMB was a worrisome proposition that needed to be addressed on priority, more so with the backdrop of intelligence reports suggesting the attempts of IIGs in forming organizations such as the United National Liberation Front of Western South East Asia (UNLFWSA) and Coordination Committee (CorCom).

It is with this backdrop that the idea of conducting Operation Sunrise was mooted by us to disrupt the prevailing ecosystem of IIGs, an apt name for this iconic operation as it happens to be the insignia of Eastern Command as well. Conducted in two parts in February and May 2019, Operation Sunrise turned out to be a huge success, enabling long-lasting dividends. Besides the large number of physical casualties suffered by the IIGs (around twenty to thirty fatal), the main achievement was actually the success we got in disrupting the IIGs in their comfort zone of well-established camps. This, in turn, rattled the IIG and EAG leadership in equal measure. There were large-scale desertions and fleeing insurgent cadres got trapped by our AR and Army columns on our side of the IMB. Apprehensions of IIGs during the period of Operation Sunrise witnessed an almost 300 per cent surge, with about 150 apprehensions in just seven days. Consequently, many unholy alliances between the groups not only got severed but ideas such as CorCom and UNLFWSA

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